

Md Ali

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SUMMARY

Virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) with 10+ years of experience spanning offensive security, cybersecurity research, and enterprise risk management. Proven track record supporting organizations in strengthening security posture through penetration testing, Security Risk Assessments (SRAs), and governance, risk, and compliance (GRC) initiatives across healthcare, education, and financial sectors. Skilled at translating complex technical findings into clear executive-level risk insights that drive strategic decision-making, regulatory readiness, and long-term security program maturity. Combines hands-on consulting expertise with academic leadership and cybersecurity workforce development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) – DOT Security Jan 2026 – Present

- Serve as executive-level cybersecurity leader for organizations without in-house security leadership, providing strategic and risk-based guidance.
- Advise executive stakeholders on security governance, regulatory expectations, and organizational risk posture.
- Translate penetration testing results, vulnerability assessments, and Security Risk Assessments into prioritized remediation roadmaps aligned with business impact.
- Establish baseline security posture assessments for new clients, identifying control gaps across people, process, and technology.
- Provide ongoing security leadership through quarterly risk reviews, executive briefings, and roadmap updates aligned to organizational priorities.
- Review and refine security policies, standards, and procedures to support consistent and repeatable risk management practices.

Professor & Program Coordinator (Cybersecurity) – Olive-Harvey College Aug 2024 – Present

- Lead cybersecurity workforce development programs aligned with employer needs and current industry practices.
- Design and deliver applied instruction in ethical hacking, penetration testing, cybersecurity fundamentals, and defensive security concepts.
- Develop hands-on labs and simulations reflecting real-world enterprise security environments and attacker methodologies.
- Integrate risk assessment, vulnerability analysis, and incident response concepts into curriculum to reinforce operational security thinking.
- Collaborate with faculty and industry partners to continuously refine curriculum relevance and student outcomes.

Cybersecurity Consultant – Burwood Group Inc. Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

- Led end-to-end penetration testing engagements across healthcare, education, and financial clients, including scoping, execution, reporting, and executive briefings.
- Conducted external, internal, and web application assessments targeting enterprise networks, servers, endpoints, and business-critical applications.
- Performed 25+ Security Risk Assessments annually, mapping technical findings to NIST CSF, HIPAA, and PCI DSS requirements.
- Authored executive-ready reports articulating risk, impact, likelihood, and remediation priorities.
- Advised client security and IT teams on remediation strategies, contributing to measurable reductions in assessed risk exposure.

- Delivered remote instruction across ethical hacking, network security, Linux security, digital forensics, and incident response.
- Developed hands-on labs simulating real-world security scenarios to reinforce applied learning.
- Guided adult learners transitioning into cybersecurity roles through technical instruction and mentorship.
- Emphasized attacker tradecraft, defensive decision-making, and risk-based thinking throughout instruction.

EDUCATION

Capitol Technology University <i>Doctor of Philosophy • Computer Science</i>	May 2025
Illinois Institute of Technology <i>Master of Science • Computer Science</i>	Dec 2022
Illinois Institute of Technology <i>Master of Science • Applied Cybersecurity & Digital Forensics</i>	Aug 2020
Texas State University <i>Bachelor of Science • Physics & Applied Mathematics</i>	May 2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security: Penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, network and web application testing, attacker methodology

Security Tools: Huntress, KnowBe4, SentinelOne, Cynomi, Cloudflare, ProofPoint

Governance, Risk & Compliance: NIST CSF, CMMC, HIPAA, PCI DSS, Security Risk Assessments, policy and control evaluation

Operating Systems & Networking: Linux and Windows environments, TCP/IP fundamentals, enterprise network concepts

Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) – *In Progress*
- Practical Network Penetration Tester (PNPT) – TCM Security
- Practical Junior Penetration Tester (PJPT) – TCM Security

ACHIEVEMENTS & SERVICE

- Founder and Faculty Advisor, Hacking Club — Olive-Harvey College
- Speaker, OWASP SnowFroc Colorado (2024)
- Guest Speaker, Corporate Strategy Podcast (2024)
- Judge, Global OSINT Search Party CTF (2022–2025)
- Mentor, Women in Cybersecurity (WiCyS)
- Member, Association for Computing Machinery (ACM)
- Member, Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)
- Volunteer Lead, Rizal Filipino Community Center — Chicago